The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Jayavatī

Āryajayavatīnāmadhāraṇī · Toh 1004 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་རྒྱལ་བ་ཅན་ཞེས་བྱ་བའི་གཟུངས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Jayavatī, known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Jayavatī Nāma Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Pakpa Gyalwachen, is a short scripture centered on a protective incantation described as a "great queen of spells." It opens on Vulture Peak near Rājagṛha, where the Buddha is staying with a thousand monks, and Vajrapāṇi, the great general of the yakṣas, approaches and asks him to proclaim this spell out of loving care for all beings and for the welfare and happiness of the kings of men. Its focus on victory and protection, especially for rulers, reflects the practical aims common to this kind of literature. The work is Toh 1004 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the dhāraṇī texts, the collection of scriptures devoted to sacred spells and their recitation.

In the language of India: ārya jayavatī nāma dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called Jayavatī.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was staying at Rājagṛha, on Vulture Peak, together with a great Saṅgha of monks, a full thousand monks. Then Vajrapāṇi, the great general of the yakṣas, went to where the Blessed One was. When he arrived, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and said this to the Blessed One:

"Out of loving care for all sentient beings, for the benefit of all sentient beings, and for the benefit and happiness of the kings of men, may the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly and completely awakened Buddha, please proclaim this great queen of spells called Jayavatī."

Then the Blessed One, regarding Vajrapāṇi, the great general of the yakṣas, with loving care, proclaimed the great queen of spells Jayavatī:

"Vajrapāṇi, take hold of this queen of spells called Jayavatī, spoken and blessed by many hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of buddhas, which I too now proclaim for the benefit, the happiness, and out of compassion for all sentient beings:

tadyathā jaye jaye jaye mahājayavātiye buddha adhiṣṭhite dharma avabhāsani buddha adhigame jñāna avabhāse svāhā

Vajrapāṇi, these are the bases of secret mantra empowered at the crown by the Tathāgata. Vajrapāṇi, whoever ties these words, empowered at the crown by the Tathāgata, onto the body, or writes them in a book, for a thousand yojanas around that person's body no harm from adversaries will arise. Weapons, poison, and venom will not harm them. In that king's country no harm from enemies will arise. Adversaries will not harm that realm by their power.

Vajrapāṇi, whatever son of good family or daughter of good family writes down this queen of spells Jayavatī and carries it, for as long as that person lives, weapons, poison, water, epidemics, and other concocted poisons will not harm their body. Fear of enemies, violence, and abuse will not befall them. Fear of kings will not arise, and fear of bandits and thieves will not arise. Even if they go into battle, weapons will not strike their body. Everywhere they will declare, 'I am victorious.' Unharmed, unhurt, and unwounded, by the might, splendor, power, and blessing of this queen of spells Jayavatī, they will be victorious.

tadyathā jaye jaye jayottame dharma avabhasani buddha buddha dhara dhara dhara dhara bodhani bodhani bodhani tathāgata adhiṣṭhite avarohani arobyani jayakusume svare saravatī dṛḍhe dṛḍhe dadādṛḍhapāśaribaddhe ohani mohani jambhani stambhani stambhita sarva ahitiṣṭhiṇāṃ namo bhagavati buddhasya mahāgaruṇāṃ viharini siddhyantu manjapadā svāhā"

Then Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, said this to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, through the might of the Buddha and the blessing of the Buddha, I shall pronounce the bases of secret mantra of the dhāraṇī of this queen of spells Jayavatī:

tadyathā jaya jaya jaya phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ jvala jvala jvala vajraprahara prahara prahara dhara dhara dhara hara hara hara bhara bhara bhara jalakusume bala bala cakra cakra vīḍaya vīḍaya akrama akrama vikrame vikrame acale macale khagacāriṇi nīlavatī vajrapraharani vajrapraharani vajrasambhave vajrakāye buddha adhiṣṭhite buddharasmi mahāprabhe ucchakandhe mahātejavatī macale pacale dhuna dhuna dhuna kakakaṃre kāsini samāhite dharma avabhasani cara cara ghughuḍe vajramālādhari sara sara kalakalapariṇi svāhā

Blessed One, these bases of secret mantra were spoken by nine hundred and ninety million buddhas. Whoever transgresses this great queen of spells Jayavatī will have offended against those buddhas, those blessed ones. These are gods, nāgas, yakṣas, rākṣasas, pretas, piśācas, apasmāras, killers, kākhordas, vetālas, inauspicious ones, mātṛkā grahas, ancestral grahas,

Skandas, Skanda grahas, and devouring grahas. All of these I have stupefied, and I have paralyzed them.

tadyathā vajre vajre vajre hana vajre nihana vajre khāda khāda vajroṇa sphāṭaya sphāṭaya vajreṇa edaṃ gṛhana hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ grasa grasa grasa pātaya pātaya pātaya dhara dhara

Protect, protect me and all sentient beings from all fears and all harms, and from all fights, battles, disputes, and quarrels!

jayakāri jayikuru tara tara tara mahātaraṇe suṭe kuṭe kuṭe vajrakuṭe svāhā"

Then the Blessed One gave his approval to Vajrapāṇi, the great general of the yakṣas, saying "Excellent!":

"Excellent, excellent, Vajrapāṇi! Vajrapāṇi, great being, it is excellent too that you have set out to act for the benefit and happiness of sentient beings and out of compassion for them. Vajrapāṇi, whoever comes to hold this great queen of spells Jayavatī in their hands and ties it onto the body or writes it in a book, wherever it is kept and put into practice, whether in a village, a town, a market town, a monastery, or a dwelling, there the Great King Vaiśravaṇa, together with his host of attendants, will protect that village, town, market town, or country. That country will not be harmed by enemy armies. In that region misfortune will not arise, and enemies will not arise. The Great King Vaiśravaṇa, together with hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of yakṣas who follow behind him, will guard that place there. He will fully protect it.

He will take it fully under his care. He will bring about peace and well-being. He will avert punishment. He will avert weapons. He will destroy poison. He will hold back enemies. He will seal the boundaries. He will seal the ground.

tadyathā tavani tavani pratapani dhurume dhurume buddha adhiṣṭhite mukhe mukhe sumukhe sumukhe prala pralate samādhite samādhigarbhe samādhigarbhe mānasi phuru phuru phuru dhuru buddha mānasike svāhā

Vajrapāṇi, these are the empowerment conferred from the crown of the Tathāgata's head. They are the secret abode. They are the secret of all the tathāgatas. They are blessed by all the tathāgatas.

Vajrapāṇi, suppose a king of men writes this queen of vidyā-mantras, Jayavatī, carefully in a book and keeps it, or ties it onto his body and wears it. Suppose he honors it with a profusion of incense, garlands, unguents and flowers of every kind, venerates it, reveres it, and makes offerings to it. Then the Great King Vaiśravaṇa, together with the many hundreds of thousands of koṭis of

niyutas of yakṣas who follow behind him, will protect that king of men. No opponents, enemies or hostile armies will find any opening against that king of men. Even if sorcery and obstructors enter that land, the Great King Vaiśravaṇa will raise against them hundreds of obstacles of every kind, thousands of obstacles of every kind.

Wherever the king of men goes, this great queen of vidyā-mantras, Jayavatī, should be tied to the top of a victory banner and carried before him in honor. Wherever he goes into battle or fights a great enemy, this great queen of vidyā-mantras, Jayavatī, should be tied at his neck. When he enters battle, the Great King Vaiśravaṇa will defeat the hostile army there. He will make him victorious. Whoever has this great queen of vidyā-mantras, Jayavatī, tied at the neck will be victorious.

Vajrapāṇi, if in any village, town, market town, district or royal palace various epidemics and great, terrible calamities arise, one should set out this great queen of vidyā-mantras, Jayavatī, together with flowers of every kind, the rites, tormas, and four vases filled with various drinks placed in the four directions. If one then recites this great queen of vidyā-mantras, Jayavatī, the Great King Vaiśravaṇa, with his host of attendants and together with many hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of yakṣas, will completely pacify that epidemic and calamity.

Then Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, there is no vidyā-mantra beyond this one, none more powerful, none of greater splendor, none of greater miraculous power, none of greater might. It is the supreme of all vidyā-mantras. In whatever land this great queen of vidyā-mantras, Jayavatī, is put into practice, in every such place it will perform the deeds of a buddha.

tadyathā vajre vajre vajre amṛta vajro jvalita vajra hutāśani bhañja bhañja bhañja bhañja jambha stambhaya sarva grahāṇāṃ hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ phaṭ grasa grasa grasa paṭa paṭa paṭa taṭa taṭa taṭa muru muru muru dhama dhama dhama jvala jvala jvala khukhume khukhume ghori ghori ghori vajra mānasi vajra huti hutiru phuru phuru grasa grasa sarva ahitiṣiṇāṃ nāburuṇi mumule vajra pradīpāni cimale phu svāhā āyuḥpālani cucure svāhā jaye jaye jaya sambhave svāhā jayottame svāhā jaya varede svāhā jayantare svāhā jaya mānasi svāhā jaya vajra svāhā ajita vajrāya svāhā mahā vajra hutāśanāya svāhā amogha vajra hastaya svāhā"

Then the Great King Vaiśravaṇa went to where the Blessed One was. Having arrived, he bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet and said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, I too shall grant protection to this Dharma discourse. I shall fully safeguard it and fully uphold it. I shall avert punishment, avert weapons, destroy poison, hold back enemies, and prevent untimely death. I shall ward off all fights, quarrels, disputes, strife, battles, tumults and fears. I shall seal the boundaries.

tadyathā jaye jeye jaye mahājaye mili manasi jhe jhe jhe muru muru tuṭu tuṭu mumule mārgavati dūdhume vege vegadhāriṇī tejavatī Protect me and all sentient beings from all fears and harms and from all untimely death, protect us! svāhā

Blessed One, these foundations of the secret mantra of the dhāraṇī were spoken and blessed by ninety-nine koṭis of buddhas.

tadyathā buddhe buddhe buddhe buddhe buddhavatī buddha avabhasani dharmavatī samahite samādhigarbhe buddha avabhasani buddha parihari dharma avabhāsani svāhā

Whoever transgresses this great queen of vidyā-mantras, Jayavatī, his head will split into seven pieces like a taka fruit. If anyone keeps this great queen of vidyā-mantras, Jayavatī, reads it, worships it, copies it out in letters, or writes it in a book and places it in a village, a town, a market town, a district, a royal palace or a monastery, then I, with my host of attendants and together with many hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of yakṣas, shall follow behind that holder of the vidyā-mantra and protect him. I shall seal the boundaries for up to a hundred thousand yojanas. I shall bring it about that there are no opponents, enemies, battles, fights, fault-finders, quarrels or strife of any kind. I shall turn them back."

Then the Blessed One gave his approval to the Great King Vaiśravaṇa, saying "Excellent!": "Great King, excellent, excellent!

"Great being, it is excellent as well that you have set out to benefit the whole world, out of compassion for all sentient beings, for their happiness, and to protect the teaching. Whoever is fully protected, fully upheld and fully guarded by this great queen of vidyā-mantras, Jayavatī, that person's body cannot be overcome by weapons, poison, kākhordas, killers, epidemics or any harm at all. This great queen of vidyā-mantras, Jayavatī, is sealed with the seal of the Tathāgata.

"Vajrapāṇi, you must take up this great queen of vidyā-mantras, Jayavatī! Keep it! Master it completely!

"Vajrapāṇi, in the future, in later times, in the final five hundred years, when the true Dharma is being utterly destroyed, there will appear violent beings, extremely fierce, yakṣas and rākṣasas who steal vitality, and kings who practice what is contrary to the Dharma. When short-lived rulers appear who govern the realm without regard for the Dharma, at that time this great queen of vidyā-mantras, Jayavatī, will act to subdue those of uneven and harsh minds, and all beings who are hostile and deeply hostile.

"This great queen of vidyā-mantras, Jayavatī, which utterly destroys all the maṇḍalas of the māras, has been spoken, blessed and sealed by many hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of buddhas. This great queen of vidyā-mantras, Jayavatī, is revered by all the gods."

Then Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, what is the name of this Dharma discourse? How should it be held?"

The Blessed One declared: "Vajrapāṇi, therefore you should hold it as 'The Essence and Seal of the Tathāgata.' Hold it also as 'Jayavatī, Which Utterly Destroys All the Maṇḍalas of the Māras.'"

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, Vajrapāṇi, the Lord of Secrets, the Great King Vaiśravaṇa, and the world with its gods, humans, asuras and gandharvas rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This concludes the noble dhāraṇī called Jayavatī.

Translator's Notes

• A few terms in the list of harmful beings are uncertain.
- "Killers" renders the Tibetan for "one who kills," possibly Skt. māraka.
- "Kākhordas" is a conjectural identification of a Tibetan term that can also mean sorcery or a sorcery spirit (kṛtyā).
- "Ancestral grahas" renders a term meaning literally "the grahas of the ones above." Its Sanskrit equivalent is unclear.
- "Skanda" follows the standard equation of the Tibetan "the one who dries up" with that name.
- "Apasmāra" (Tibetan "one who causes forgetting") denotes a spirit causing epilepsy or loss of memory.

The word rendered "misfortune" in the closing section is of uncertain meaning. It may stand for famine or untimely death, or it may be a corruption.

The verb rendered "will have offended against" those buddhas is also uncertain. It could also be understood as "will be at odds with."

The passage does not make clear how the list of harmful beings relates to the sentence before it. It is rendered here as identifying the transgressors.
• □□□□ in this protective list is taken as "punishment" (judicial penalty), as is usual in dhāraṇī protection formulas, not the philosophical sense "annihilation." The phrase about Vaiśravaṇa "making hundreds and thousands of various obstacles" is taken to mean he raises obstacles against the intruding sorcery and obstructors; the Tibetan is terse. The "taka fruit" in the head-splitting formula is uncertain. Parallels usually name the arjaka plant, but the text as written has □□□, so it is kept as is.
• In the title "The Essence and Seal of the Tathāgata," the term usually rendered tathāgatagarbha (buddha-nature) is here part of a scriptural title. It is taken in its sense of the "heart" or "essence" of the Tathāgata, not as the doctrine of buddha-nature. The number "koṭis of niyutas" renders the Tibetan for a vast count (Skt. koṭiniyuta).

In the sentence about subduing the hostile, the Tibetan reads "kyi don du" ("for the sake of / with regard to") after "all beings who are hostile and deeply hostile." It is taken here as marking those beings as the ones to be subdued. It could also be read as "for the sake of all beings."

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.